AI-READY OPERATIONS · EPISODE CHEAT SHEET · THE FAST LANE

Your team already uses AI you banned. Build them a faster yes.

A ban does not stop the usage. It removes your **visibility**. The fix is a lane: **a name, a clock, a map** – one page that makes it easier to ask than to hide it.

THE EVIDENCE

66%
used an AI tool at work while believing it was not permitted

88%
of that same group shared real work information with a public AI tool

PagerDuty / Wakefield Research, 2026 Shadow AI Survey (n=1,250) – survey commissioned by PagerDuty, an IT-operations vendor. Scale: **52%** of US workers use AI in their role, **15%** daily (Gallup, n=22,573, May 2026, independent). The ban was already in force for those people. It stopped nobody.

THE FAST LANE – THREE PARTS, EVERY WORKING VERSION

A NAME
One person with the real authority to answer. Not a committee – if a request goes to everybody, nobody answers it.

A CLOCK
Yes or no inside a day. A maybe doesn't count. The clock is a promise to your people.

A MAP
One page, three lists. Nobody reads a forty-page policy on a deadline. Everybody understands green, yellow and red.

GREEN
already approved – use it today, no questions

YELLOW
ask – answer by tomorrow, written down

RED
full review – one honest sentence on why

THE MONDAY MOVE – PUBLISH THE GREEN PAGE

ONE PAGE, THREE LINES, THIS WEEK

1. **The green list** – the two or three tools already in use that you can live with, marked approved.
2. **The one name** – who answers, starting this week. If that person is you, write you.
3. **The clock** – answer by tomorrow. The first time a request sits for a week, people go back to working around you.

WHERE IT SITS

1	2	3	4	5
GOVERNANCE	CLEAN DATA	STANDARDIZED PROCESSES	CONTROLS	OPERATING MODEL

"The fix for shadow AI is not a better no. It is a faster yes."

Free AI-Ready Operations Assessment – all five layers, 10–15 min, no email drip – vihrenlabs.gumroad.com/l/rmkje

VIHREN LABS · vihrenlabs.com
Education and operator practice, not consulting, legal, or vendor advice. Views my own. Two sources are cited, Gallup (independent) and a PagerDuty-sponsored survey, both disclosed on screen. The first-week example is hypothetical.

Don't build better AI.
Build better operations.